

Final answers (record here — graded on the answer; show your work):

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____ 5. _____ 6. _____ 7. _____
8. _____ 9. _____ 10. _____ 11. _____ 12. _____ 13. _____
14. _____ 15. _____

Warm-Up: Identify a

Example (Warm-Up: Identify a):

For $y = 4(x - 1)^2 + 2$, $a = 4$.

Directions: State the value of a for each equation and whether the parabola opens up or down.

1. $y = 3(x - 1)^2 + 2$

3. $y = \frac{1}{4}(x - 2)^2 - 3$

2. $y = -2(x + 5)^2 + 1$

4. $y = -x^2 + 6$

Identify the Vertex

Example (Identify the Vertex):

For $y = -2(x + 4)^2 + 7$, rewrite $(x + 4)$ as $(x - (-4))$, so the vertex is $(-4, 7)$.

Directions: Identify the vertex (h, k) for each equation. Show the rewritten form when needed.

5. $y = (x - 5)^2 + 3$

8. $y = 5(x + 7)^2$

6. $y = 2(x + 2)^2 - 6$

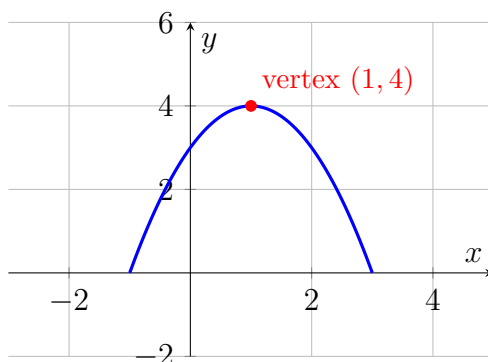
9. $y = -4(x - 9)^2 - 1$

7. $y = -\frac{1}{2}(x - 0)^2 + 8$

Full Identification

Example (Full Identification):

For $y = -3(x - 2)^2 + 5$: $a = -3$ (opens down, narrower), vertex $(2, 5)$.



The graph of $y = -(x - 1)^2 + 4$.

Directions: For each equation, state a , the vertex, and the direction of opening.

10. $y = -(x - 1)^2 + 4$ (use the graph above to confirm your answer) 12. $y = -\frac{1}{3}(x - 6)^2 + 1$

11. $y = 2(x + 3)^2 - 5$

13. $y = 6(x + 1)^2 + 2$

Challenge (same sheet):

14. Write a vertex-form equation whose parabola opens down with vertex $(-3, 5)$ and is narrower than $y = x^2$.
15. Two parabolas both have vertex $(2, -1)$, but one has $a = 4$ and the other has $a = \frac{1}{4}$. Explain how their graphs would differ.

Answer Key — fully worked

Procedure: Compare the equation to the pattern $y = a(x - h)^2 + k$.; Read off a – the number multiplied on the squared term.; Rewrite $(x \pm h)$ as $(x - h)$ if needed to correctly identify the sign of h .; Read off k – the constant added or subtracted at the end.; Write the vertex as the ordered pair (h, k) .; State the direction of opening: up if $a > 0$, down if $a < 0$..

1. $a = 3$, opens up.
2. $a = -2$, opens down.
3. $a = \frac{1}{4}$, opens up.
4. $a = -1$, opens down.
5. Vertex $(5, 3)$.
6. Vertex $(-2, -6)$.
7. Vertex $(0, 8)$.
8. Vertex $(-7, 0)$.
9. Vertex $(9, -1)$.
10. $a = -1$, vertex $(1, 4)$, opens down – matches the graph shown.
11. $a = 2$, vertex $(-3, -5)$, opens up.
12. $a = -\frac{1}{3}$, vertex $(6, 1)$, opens down.
13. $a = 6$, vertex $(-1, 2)$, opens up.
14. Vertex $(-3, 5)$ means $h = -3$, $k = 5$; opens down means $a < 0$; narrower than $y = x^2$ means $|a| > 1$. One valid answer: $y = -2(x + 3)^2 + 5$ (any coefficient with $a < -1$ works, e.g. $y = -3(x + 3)^2 + 5$).
15. Both share vertex $(2, -1)$ and open up, but $a = 4$ makes the first parabola narrower (a vertical stretch, steeper), while $a = \frac{1}{4}$ makes the second wider (a vertical compression, flatter). At the same horizontal distance from the axis, the $a = 4$ graph rises 16 times higher than the $a = \frac{1}{4}$ graph.